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MART 120

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The Last Lecture's Message

Overall, Randy Pausch's lecture is about childhood dreams and how to achieve them. Throughout the course of the video, he goes down the list of major dreams he had as a kid, explaining how he did or didn't reach them. Whether it was wanting to be in zero gravity or simply win big stuffed animals, in each dream shares a humorous story about pursuing it, and in turn, the great advice he received, the obstacles he encountered, and how inventing ways around those obstacles led him to find success, enable others to also achieve their dreams, and embrace obstacles as opportunities. It is a lecture made not only to inspire others to have a positive mindset, but a message to his family about leaving a lasting impact.

As for a message I identify with, and that affected me the most, that would have to be his statement, "Brick walls are there for a reason: they let us prove how badly we want things." In working towards my goals, I've often put myself down over failure. Though I'm working to have a better growth mindset, I've wondered why achieving my dreams has to be so taxing. I've questioned why people and problems must constantly stand in the way, and Pausch's statement is a great reminder. Without obstacles, dreams wouldn't feel worth pursuing because everyone would succeed without trying. Everything would be easy, and no result would feel monumental. His words showed me why obstacles exist. There needs to be an intentional filter, something to keep dreams from being pointless, and instead, drive people to work hard, inspire others, and be the best they can be for the world.

